

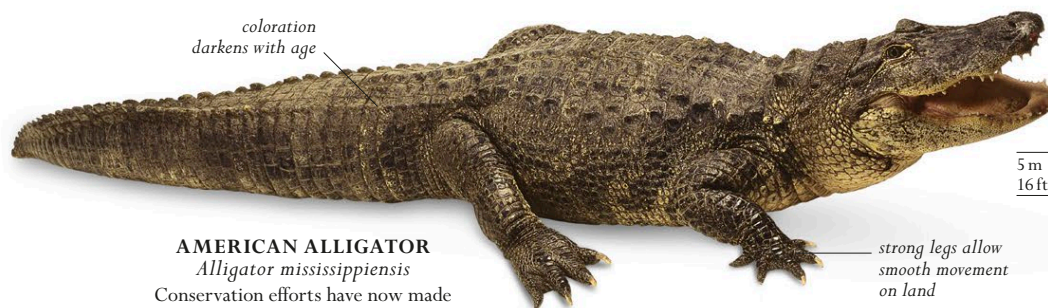
ALLIGATORS AND CAIMANS

Members of the family Alligatoridae feed on fish, birds, and mammals that share their aquatic habitat. These reptiles are distributed throughout freshwater swamps and rivers of the tropical and subtropical Americas. The only species living outside the Americas is the rare Chinese alligator.



SPECTACLED CAIMAN
Caiman crocodilus

This caiman feeds on a wide range of prey. Widespread in C. and S. America, it appears to be the only crocodilian that readily occupies man-made aquatic habitats.



AMERICAN ALLIGATOR
Alligator mississippiensis
Conservation efforts have now made this N. American species quite common. It preys on birds, small mammals, and turtles.



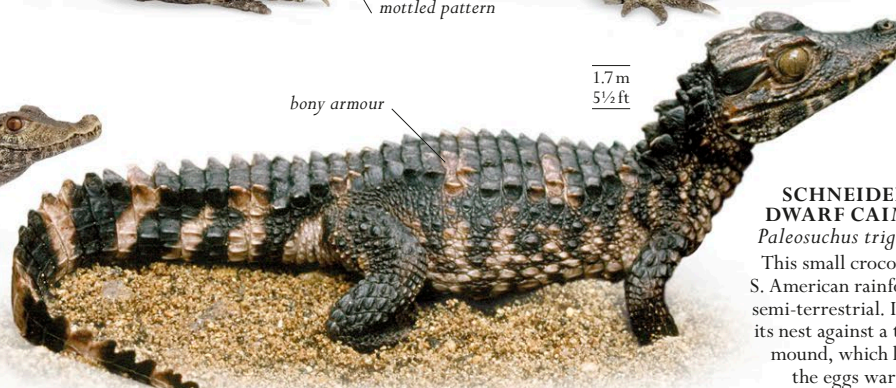
CHINESE ALLIGATOR
Alligator sinensis
This critically endangered species of the Yangtze valley of China lies dormant in burrows during the cold winter months.



BROAD-SNOUDED CAIMAN
Caiman latirostris
A mound-nesting species found across much of central S. America, this caiman is characterized by a broad snout. It hunts mammals and birds.



CUVIER'S DWARF CAIMAN
Paleosuchus palpebrosus
This S. American species is the smallest of the New World members of this order. It has a dog-like skull and bony armoured skin.



SCHNEIDER'S DWARF CAIMAN
Paleosuchus trigonatus
This small crocodile of S. American rainforests is semi-terrestrial. It builds its nest against a termite mound, which keeps the eggs warm.



SALTWATER CROCODILE
Crocodylus porosus

The largest of all living reptiles, this common Indo-Pacific species readily crosses the open ocean. Its diet is wide-ranging and unspecialized.



NILE CROCODILE
Crocodylus niloticus
Widely distributed in Africa, this large crocodile typically lives in fresh water but has been seen around coasts as well. Its diet varies with age, with adults taking larger prey.